

Phase 9 Visual Asset Direction

Branch: phase-9-visual-asset-direction · Base commit before Phase 9 commit: 1d5cf82

Purpose: create a reviewable asset-direction packet for Darts & Pats without adding exhibit sections or committing full production art integration. Draft generated assets remain in a preview route and prototype folder.

Canonical date range fixed to 1991–2026. The Parade intro, threshold copy, timeline constants, and data all now align with the enriched archive, which contains 2026 records.

What Changed

Date copy	The Breeze Parade intro now says 1991–2026, matching the data and threshold.
Draft assets	Six opaque concept rasters were generated and normalized into public/assets/prototypes/phase-9/.
Preview route	/phase-9-asset-preview/ compares current UI treatments with asset-enhanced concepts.
Documentation	docs/PHASE_9_ASSET_DIRECTION.md records prompts, risks, and integration recommendations.

What Did Not Change

The live exhibit structure, navigation, sections, reading drawer behavior, Editor Table interaction, Class-of behavior, and Follow the Strings logic were not redesigned. Generated art is not wired into the live exhibit. Labels and records remain HTML text.

Visual Directions

A. Archival newspaper corridor

Paper-forward, quiet, tactile, slightly tense. Warm paper dominates; purple is structure, gold is tape/pin warmth. Best for rail, drawer, cards, and corridor surfaces. Risk: too much paper texture can flatten hierarchy.

B. Whimsical civic parade

Public, warm, animated, inviting, and memory-lane without becoming childish. Best for attractor mode. Risk: scenic detail can compete with title, button, and clipping card.

C. Museum memory wall / card-catalog

Organized but odd: drawer tabs, tickets, pins, corkboard, and student-newspaper memory slips. Best for Class-of, Memory Rail, and Follow the Strings. Risk: too many artifact metaphors can make the exhibit busy again.

Asset Inventory And Recommendations

File	Type	Dimensions	Recommendation
parade-background-landscape-draft.png	Background	3840x2160	Possibly integrate after signage/contrast review; use behind HTML overlays with a soft scrim.
parade-background-portrait-draft.png	Background	2160x3840	Possibly integrate after portrait overlap review; keep top and middle calm.
clipping-card-texture-draft.png	Texture/card surface	1200x800	Best near-term candidate; test at controlled opacity under card text.
memory-rail-tab-concept-draft.png	Object sheet/concept	900x1800	Do not integrate directly; recreate as CSS/SVG or cut verified transparent objects.
class-of-ticket-concept-draft.png	Object/texture concept	1400x700	Maybe as subtle background; likely better as CSS/SVG for responsive controls.
corkboard-string-board-texture-draft.png	Background/texture	2400x1600	Defer until Follow the Strings density is reviewed; use label scrim if tested.

All six generated concept files are opaque raster images. None should be treated as transparent UI objects. Small controls and rail tabs should be rebuilt as CSS/SVG unless a future cutout workflow verifies alpha edges and contrast.

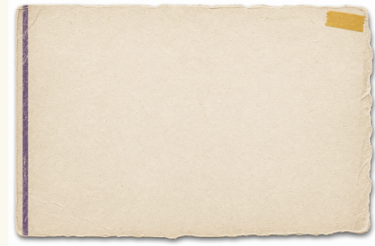
Asset Contact Sheet



parade-background-landscape-draft.png



parade-background-portrait-draft.png



clipping-card-texture-draft.png



memory-rail-tab-concept-draft.png



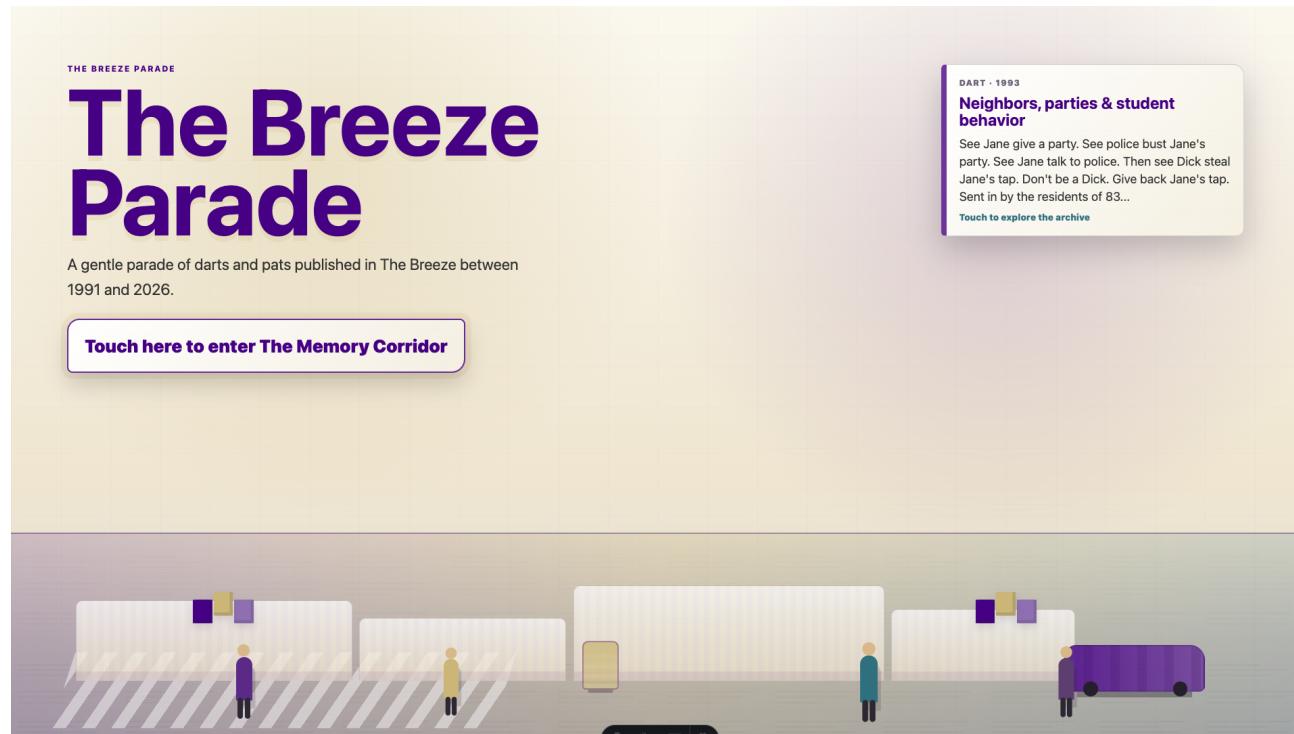
class-of-ticket-concept-draft.png



corkboard-string-board-texture-draft.png

Generated assets are concept inputs. The contact sheet labels are report annotations, not baked into the assets.

The Breeze Parade landscape current



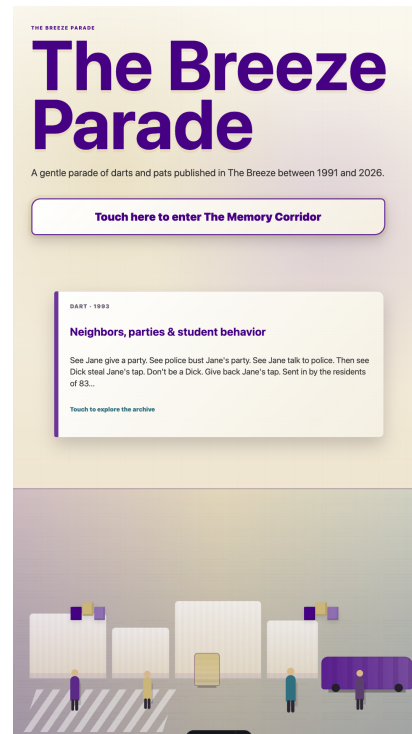
Current CSS/SVG attractor; confirms Parade copy now says 1991–2026.

The Breeze Parade landscape with draft asset



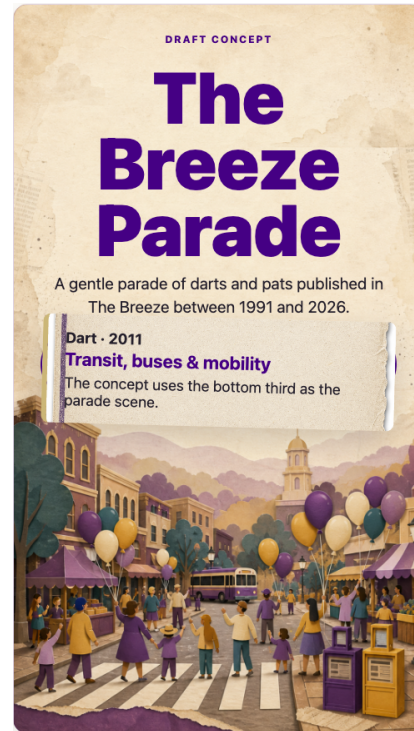
Draft civic parade background adds warmth, but the title/card need contrast review before integration.

The Breeze Parade portrait current



Phase 6 portrait poster layout remains intact.

The Breeze Parade portrait with draft asset



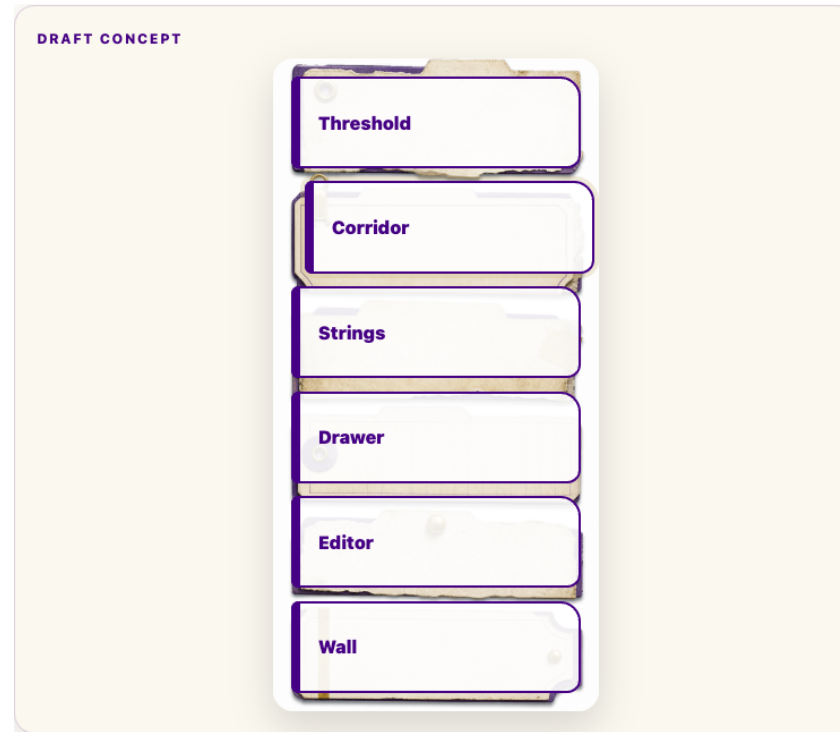
Portrait draft uses bottom-third parade scene; clipping placement still needs careful overlap testing.

Memory Rail current



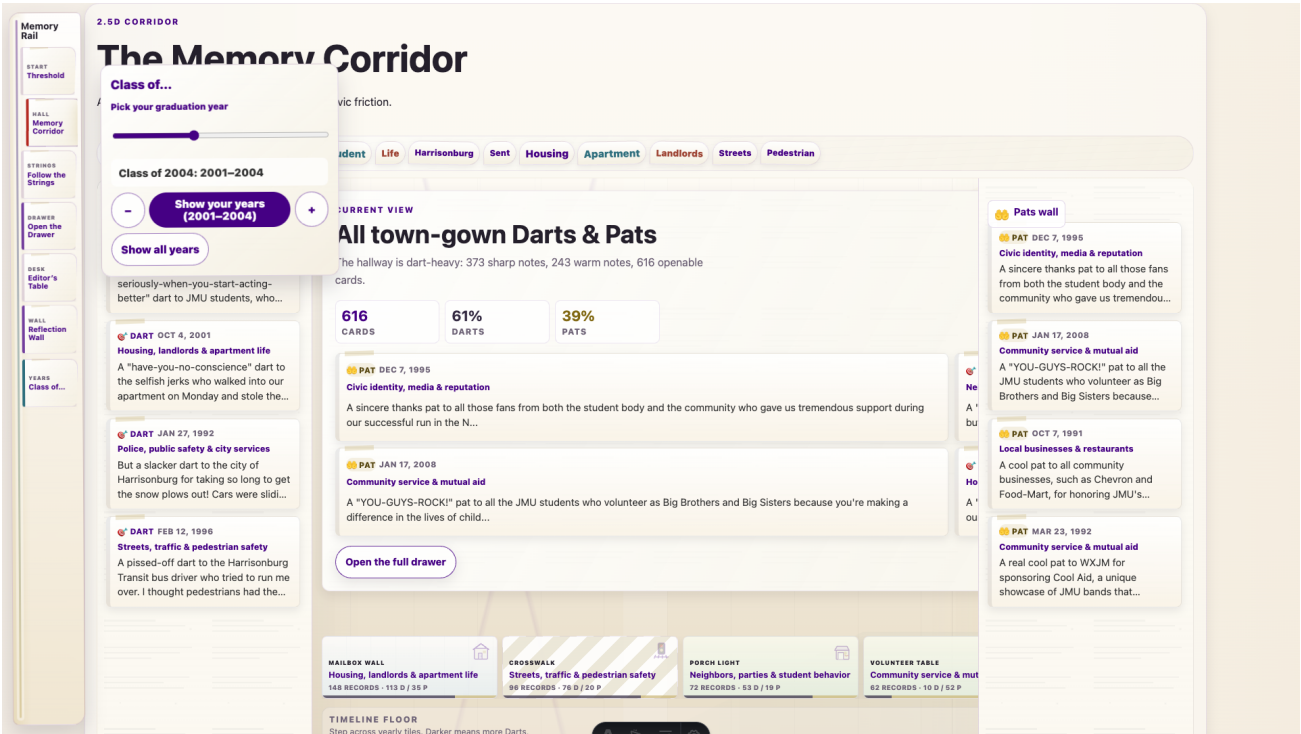
Current rail is slim and functional; physical tab language is already present in CSS.

Memory Rail with draft tab concept



Concept confirms the tab direction but should not be dropped in as an opaque sheet.

Class-of tray current



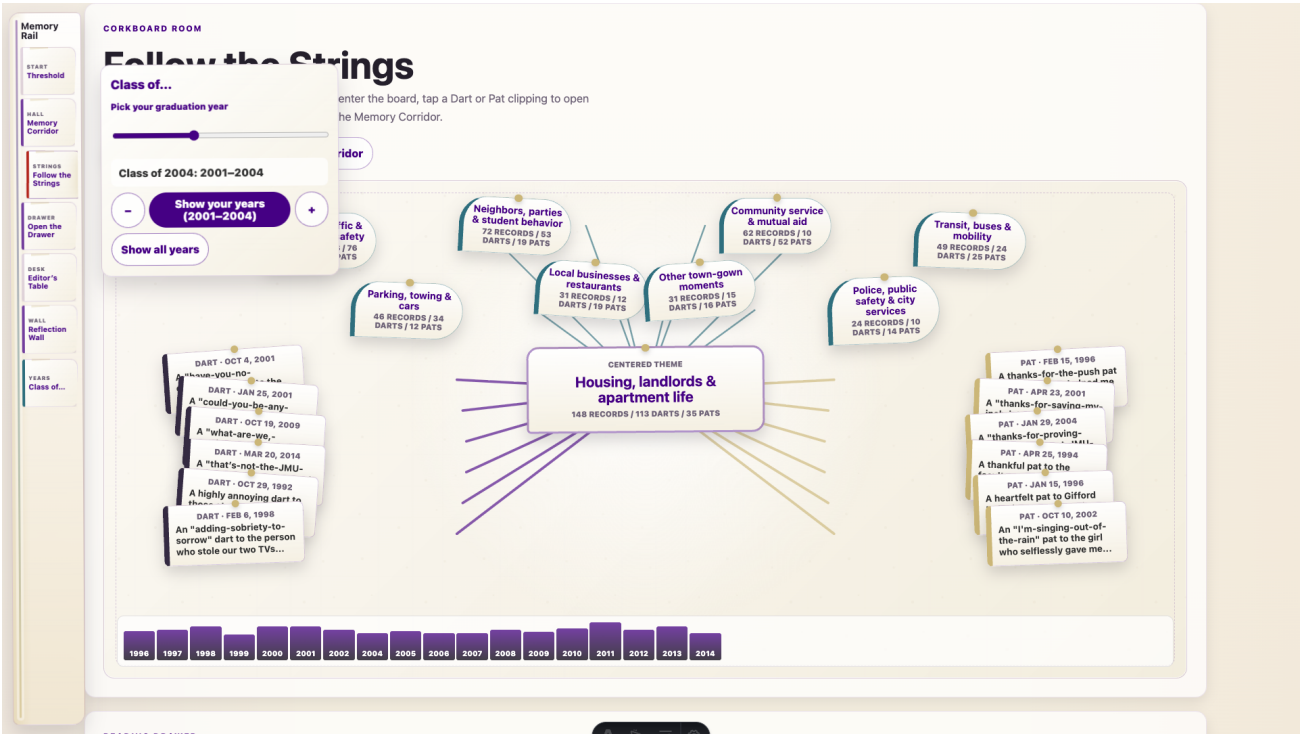
Current tray remains readable and non-form-like; range control stays HTML/touch-friendly.

Class-of tray with ticket concept



Ticket concept strengthens the object metaphor but could crowd controls if used literally.

Follow the Strings current



Current board is readable and relatively calm after previous passes.

Follow the Strings with corkboard texture concept



Texture adds room identity but is the riskiest asset for label contrast and clutter.

Reading drawer current unchanged

X

Previous
25 of 616 in this view
Next

Downtown, arts & events

To the JMU campus cadets and members of the Phi Beta Sigma Fraternity for their hours of service during our recent Jail and Bail fund-raising event. It is only through the cooperation and support of volunteers such as you that this event is possible. To date, we have raised nearly \$12,000 to go toward funding programs of cancer research, education and patient services. Sent in by Margo Kwalek and Bill Holt, co-chairs of the Jail and Bail fundraising event for the Harrisonburg/Rockingham unit of the American Cancer Society.

SOURCE The Breeze - Record #430 **ERA** 1991-1999 **SENDER** Margo Kwalek and Bill Holt **TARGET** the JMU campus cadets and members

TAGS: Downtown, arts & events Community service & mutual aid Campus edge, construction & expansion

ENTITIES: Harrisonburg Rockingham County JMU

Related by topic

PAT - APR 15, 1993
Downtown, arts & events

To the JMU Orchestra for the free concert they offered to local elementary schools. The music w...

PAT - FEB 24, 1994
Downtown, arts & events

A generous pat to Alpha Phi Omega for supporting hearing and speech-impaired persons with their...

DART - NOV 30, 1995
Downtown, arts & events

A pick-on-someone-your-own-size dart to the student who thought it was cool to ride off with th...

PAT - SEP 23, 1996
Downtown, arts & events

A "thanks-for-a-great-time" pat to Earllyn Miller and the JMU folk ensemble for putting on a gr...

Related from 1992

DART - JAN 16, 1992
Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety

An inconsiderate dart to all the local train engineers who decide to check the reverse gears on ...

DART - JAN 27, 1992
Police, public safety & city services

But a slacker dart to the city of Harrisonburg for taking so long to get the snow plows out! Ca...

DART - FEB 3, 1992
Neighbors, parties & student behavior

A brain-dead dart to all the meatheads who stand their big burly selves at the door of an off-c...

DART - FEB 13, 1992
Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety

An annoyed dart to the JMU police officer who completely ignored the pedestrian yield light in ...

Related by entity

PAT - SEP 19, 1991
Weather, environment & infrastructure

A sweaty, drippy dart goes to the unbearably hot weather we've been having lately. Why do

PAT - OCT 7, 1991
Local businesses & restaurants

A cool pat to all community businesses, such as Chevron and Food-Mart, for honoring JMU's

DART - OCT 24, 1991
Streets, traffic & pedestrian safety

Excuse me, but last I checked, pedestrians had the right of way, Harrisonburg rush hour or

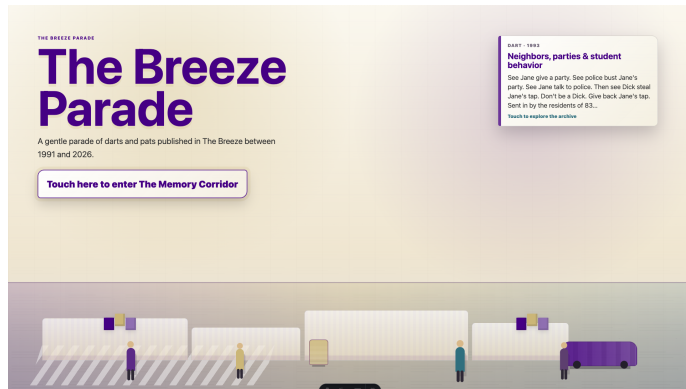
PAT - NOV 7, 1991
Community service & mutual aid

A candy-coated pat to the public-spirited members of the JMU cheerleaders and the

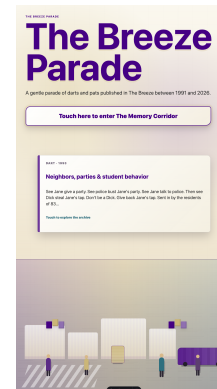
Drawer remains HTML-first; generated texture should not distract from full text and Related by Topic.

Smoke Viewports

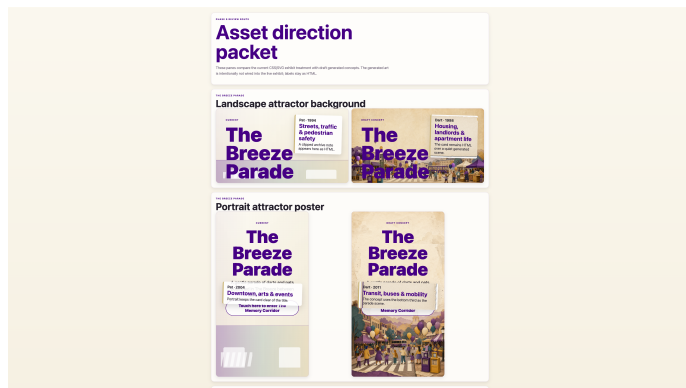
Playwright smoke captures loaded the current exhibit and preview route at landscape 1920x1080, portrait 1080x1920, 4K landscape 3840x2160, and 4K portrait 2160x3840. These were used as layout sanity checks, not production screen-bible plates.



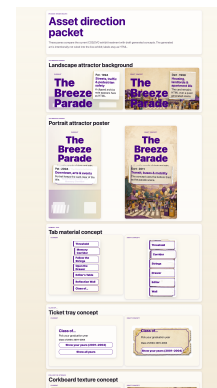
smoke-1920x1080-root.png



smoke-1080x1920-root.png



smoke-3840x2160-preview.png



smoke-2160x3840-preview.png

Contrast, Legibility, Touch Clarity, Tone

Recommended for real integration: clipping-card texture first, Parade background second after contrast scrims and crop testing. Defer or reject direct raster use of rail tabs and Class-of ticket because opaque backgrounds make responsive alignment fragile. Defer corkboard texture until Follow the Strings receives vision/human review, since it carries the highest risk of clutter.

None of the draft concepts intentionally include readable text or official logos. A human/vision review should still inspect accidental signage, pseudo-newspaper fragments, and contrast under HTML labels before production use.

StoryMap / Dashboard Check

The packet preserves the exhibit's physical metaphors: parade, clipping, rail tabs, ticket, corkboard, and drawer. The preview route is documentation-only and does not add numbered chapter dots, map-first navigation, corporate content blocks, or dashboard controls.

Remaining Risks

- Generated civic scenes may become too illustrative or busy for the attractor title and entry button.
- Opaque generated objects are not suitable for production controls unless rebuilt as CSS/SVG or cut out cleanly.
- Corkboard texture can reduce readability in the densest interactive room.
- Any accidental readable marks in generated art must be removed or avoided before public kiosk deployment.